

Monday, illustrated

Every screen below was driven by `scripts/walk_runbook.py` against a sandbox built from an empty database — signed in as the person the step belongs to, clicking the controls a person clicks. Nothing here is a mock-up and nothing was photographed from the live record.

The walk found one thing before its first screenshot. `POST /api/rates/compute` was complete on the server, named in a comment on the rates screen, and **called by nothing in the application** — so the one figure the whole engagement exists to produce could only be made by somebody running a script. Step 4 could not be performed. It can now.

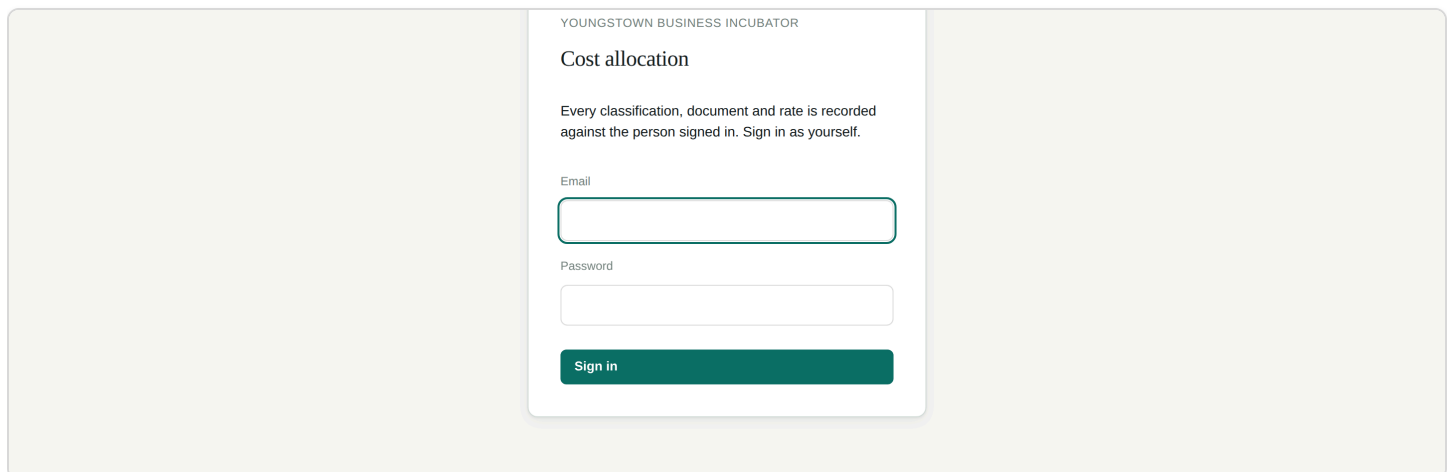
A runbook nobody has walked is a list of things somebody believes.

This walks a sandbox from an empty database, so it shows what each screen looks like and what each step means. The live record is further along — already reconciled, classified, sealed and computed — so Monday is a *review* rather than a build. What is actually outstanding, and what to do if a judgment has to change, is `docs/MONDAY_RUNBOOK.md` §0 and §C.

GETTING IN

STEP 0 Anybody /

The door. Everything below is behind somebody's own account.



YOUNGSTOWN BUSINESS INCUBATOR

Cost allocation

Every classification, document and rate is recorded against the person signed in. Sign in as yourself.

Email

Password

Sign in

Everything below is behind somebody's own account. An account on a password an administrator chose cannot write anything — not a classification, not a timesheet, not a certification — until the person changes it. The one exit from that gate is changing your own password.

What you hold, and what is yours to do today.

Youngstown Business Incubator

Cost allocation - 2025

Tom Metzinger

CONTROLLER

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Good to see you, Tom Metzinger

Classification, the seal, and the rate that follows from it — in that order, which is the order the audit file rests on.

What is waiting on you

You hold CONTROLLER, so this is everything — each row says whose work it is

What	Items	Amount	Whose	
✖ Cost to classify In P&L scope, with no live decision	757	10,180,642	CONTROLLER	Open
✖ Effort not yet certified Only the person whose effort it was can sign	43	1,835,047	PROJECT	Open
✖ Square footage not on file The facilities carve-out is sized by area	1	—	FACILITIES	Open
⚠ Employment terms missing No weekly hours to measure a timesheet against	43	1,835,047	PROJECT	Open
⚠ Invoices billing no indirect Recovery forgone on the face of it	2	38,968	PROJECT	Open

People to chase

You cannot sign these — 2 CFR 200.430(i) wants the signature of the person whose effort it was. What you can do is go and ask, and this is who, on which work.

Work	Contract	People	Wages	Stale
ESP ODSA / ESP	—	32	561,145	—
MBAC MBAC	—	10	278,466	—
YBI-GA YBI General Administration	—	10	264,445	—
HUB Hub	—	5	172,214	—
DRIVE-AM Drive AM	AM-DRIVE-AM	6	147,310	—
RISING-TIDES Rising Tides	—	7	106,398	—
YOUTH Youth Entrepreneurship	—	4	90,591	—
HYBRID-II Hybrid II	AM-HYBRID-P2	4	62,993	—
LTM Last Tactical Mile	AM-LTM-PROJ88	4	52,608	—
FUNDRAISING Fundraising / B&P	—	5	40,089	—
DIG-ENG Digital Engineering	AM-ICAM-DIGENG	2	30,700	—
XJET Xjet / Manufacturing Services	—	1	16,937	—
AM-OTHER America Makes — other	—	3	7,130	—
IIOT IIOT	—	1	2,777	—
VGW VGW Investment Fund	—	2	843	—
DLA DLA	—	1	401	—

The landing page is assembled from what you hold, not switched on a role. The tabs are what is *yours to do*; a screen you may read but have no work on is still reachable by URL. Tom holds CONTROLLER, so he sees everything — that is what the portfolio means, not a special case.

RECONCILE

STEP 1 Tom · controller /reconcile

Schedule A-1 — the eleven points where the ledger, the P&L, the balance sheet and the payroll register have to agree. This is the gate: a rate is refused while any of them is open.

Youngstown Business Incubator

Cost allocation · 2025

Tom Metzinger

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Reconciliation

A-1

Eleven points at which the general ledger, the profit and loss, the balance sheet and the payroll register are required to agree. Run before anything is classified, because a reconciliation produced after the rate is one nobody can believe.

Cross-reference points

11

Tying

11

Open

0

Everything ties

Named reconciling items

6

52,523

Controls

Ledger vs P&L (5)

Ledger vs balance sheet (4)

Reconciling items (6)

The register

What it proves	Ledger side	Statement side	Left over
✓ Profit and loss foots to the net income the sheet carries PL_FOOTING	P&L sections 4,329	Balance sheet net income 4,329	0
Net income as the P&L computes it must equal what the sheet carries in equity. Two exports that disagree are two different moments in the same books, and everything built on either is suspect.			
✓ Balance sheet balances BS_FOOTING	Assets 16,713,220	Liabilities and equity 16,713,220	0
Assets less liabilities and equity.			
✓ Every staged line reached the ledger GL_PROMOTE_COMPLETE	Dated lines staged 15,500	Lines in the ledger 15,500	0
The promote path dedupes on each line's natural key. When two genuinely different lines hash alike one is dropped and nothing raises: 71 lines carrying \$24,082.67 went that way before the key learned to number repeats. This counts them.			
✓ Printed account totals agree with the parsed lines GL_SUBTOTALS	Printed 14,371,299	Parsed 14,371,299	0
QuickBooks prints its own account totals. Reconciling against them catches almost every parsing mistake and costs nothing.			
✓ Ledger P&L-scope activity agrees with the P&L by section GL_PL_SECTION	Ledger 13,554,754	P&L 13,554,754	0
Section totals are where a mis-sectioned account shows: four leaves in this chart sit under both an income and an expense parent, and reading an expense as revenue moves the section without moving the grand total.			
✓ Ledger agrees with the P&L account by account GL_PL_ACCOUNT	Gross difference 14,940	Left unexplained 0	0 exceptions
Sections can tie while accounts do not: money moved between two expense accounts nets to nothing at the section line. Each account that differs is either a named reconciling item with the ledger lines behind it, or it is unexplained.			
✓ Every P&L account exists on both sides GL_PL_COVERAGE	Ledger accounts absent from the P&L 0	P&L accounts with no ledger lines 0	0 exceptions
A P&L account with no ledger behind it cannot be classified, and a ledger account off the P&L is cost with nowhere to land.			
✓ Opening balance plus the year's movement equals the sheet GL_BS_ACCOUNT	Accounts tied 71	Accounts off 0	0 exceptions
The tie the system could not make until the ledger's opening balances were kept. It proves the sheet off the ledger rather than trusting two exports to agree.			
✓ Accounts absent from the sheet closed at zero GL_BS_COVERAGE	Absent, closing at zero 4	Absent, carrying a balance 0	0 exceptions
QuickBooks omits an account that ends at zero, which is a complete explanation and a checkable one. An absent account still carrying a balance is a hole in the sheet.			
✓ Split lines still sum to the lines they came from SEGMENTATION	Ledger 14,371,299	Analytical 14,371,299	0
Splitting a line for classification is an analytical act on the same money. It must not change what there is.			
✓ The payroll register agrees with the ledger's wage accounts PAYROLL_REGISTER	Register 1,835,047	Ledger wage accounts 1,789,994	0 exceptions
The fringe base comes from the register, not from the ledger, so a difference here is two denominators for one rate. None of the other ten points touches the register — which is how a \$45,000 donor credit sat in an intern wage account for a year.			

Step 1, and the gate. Eleven points where the general ledger, the profit and loss, the balance sheet and the payroll register have to agree. `POST /api/rates/compute` answers 409 while any of them is open,

so nothing downstream can start here.

Read *state*, never a variance of zero: both sides of most controls are `COALESCE( ..., 0)`, so an empty period compares zero against zero and looks green. A control that cannot be evaluated has not passed.

The eleventh is the payroll register, and it is the one that pays for itself — it is how a \$45,053 donor credit sitting in an intern wage account for a year was found, which moved the fringe rate from 22.45% to 21.90%.

REVIEW

The queue, in Sweep. Every group carries its recommendation; nothing has been accepted on anybody's behalf.

Youngstown Business Incubator

Cost allocation - 2025

Tom Metzinger

CONTROLLER

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Classification

Largest groups first. Accept a proposal with one key, or open a group when it needs real thought. Progress is measured in dollars — the rate is computed only once this set is sealed.

Dollar coverage

0.0%

Groups left

757 of 757

Dollars left

10,180,642

Lines classified

0 / 4,038

Below 80% the base is incomplete, so the rate reads high. That is the honest direction to err while the work is unfinished.

Sweep

Focus

Open

Done

All

Account or vendor /

j k move

Enter accept

x select

1-8 pool

f focus

Step 2. 757 cost groups, each carrying a recommendation and none of them accepted. The log beside this screen (docs/CLASSIFICATION_LOG.md) gives a reasoned treatment for every one, with a citation and a rationale — and a named reason where there is none.

Sweep is the dense mode for the many groups with an obvious answer. j / k move, Enter accepts the proposal, 1 – 8 jump to a pool. Every second saved compounds across two hundred meaningful decisions.

STEP 2 Tom · controller /classify

Focus — one group at a time, the amount set large, the proposal as a single button. This is where the judgments that need thought are made.

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Cost allocation - 2025

Tom Metzinger

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Classification

B

Largest groups first. Accept a proposal with one key, or open a group when it needs real thought. Progress is measured in dollars — the rate is computed only once this set is sealed.

Dollar coverage

0.0%

Groups left

757 of 757

Dollars left

10,180,642

Lines classified

0 / 4,038

Below 80% the base is incomplete, so the rate reads high. That is the honest direction to err while the work is unfinished.

80% target

Sweep

Focus

Open

Done

All

Account or vendor /

Enter

accept

edit

j

k

move

f

sweep

1,678,057

5129 Payroll Expenses:5139 Wages:5140 Employee Wages

no vendor recorded - 45 lines

GROSS - Employee

GROSS - Employee

GROSS - Employee

Nothing in the account name, the Customer:Job field or last year points anywhere. This is a judgment call, and it stays in the queue until you make it rather than being defaulted into a pool.

Classify differently

Split this group

Every decision records who, when and why.

EVIDENCE

Labour needs a certification behind it
Charges to federal awards for salaries must be supported by records of actual work, certified by the person who did it. The timesheet screen is where that comes from.
2 CFR 200.430(i)

EVIDENCE

Six figures with nothing attached
\$1,678,057 carried on a judgment with no document cited. It can be graded, but not as verified.
2 CFR 200.403(g)

+ Notes and documents

Focus mode — **f** — for the few that need real thought. One group, the amount set large, sample memos for context, and the proposal as a single button.

Note what is *not* here: no rate, no preview of what this judgment would do to the rate. That absence is the guarantee. A reviewer will ask whether the rate was honest or reverse-engineered, and the answer has to be documentary rather than a promise.

STEP 3 Tom · controller /rates

Before sealing. Coverage and the reconciliation gate are both shown, and no rate exists — that is the guarantee, not a gap.

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Rates

Sealing hashes every live classification and freezes the set. Only then can a rate be computed, and the rate carries the seal — so it can be shown to be a consequence of the judgments rather than a target they were fitted to.

Before sealing

Two gates: the books must agree, and the queue should be finished

Dollar coverage

0.0%

Groups left

757

Sealing below 80% is allowed — an unfinished build should overstate rather than flatter — but finish the queue first if you can.

☒ The books agree with themselves — all 11 cross-reference points tie.

Seal decision set

80% target

Computed rates

%

No rate yet

Seal the decision set to unlock the rate phase. A database trigger refuses any rate whose seal does not match a sealed set.

Before sealing, with the queue finished. Two gates are shown and only one of them is coverage: the books must agree *and* the queue should be done. Coverage is the softer of the two — sealing below 80% is a judgment, while an open control is a refusal.

No rate exists yet. That is the design, not a gap.

STEP 3 Tom · controller /rates

Sealed. The hash covers every live judgment in the set. Only now does computing become possible.

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Cost allocation - 2025

Tom Metzinger

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D

Sealing hashes every live classification and freezes the set. Only then can a rate be computed, and the rate carries the seal — so it can be shown to be a consequence of the judgments rather than a target they were fitted to.

Sealed

Sealed by Tom Metzinger — classifications can now change only by unsealing, which supersedes the rate

Dollar coverage

100.0%

Groups left

0

The base is complete enough to seal.

☒ The books agree with themselves — all 11 cross-reference points tie.

Seal decision set

Compute the rate

Computing reads the sealed judgments and writes the rate against that seal. It is arithmetic, not a judgment — the judgment was sealing. Recomputing supersedes the rate on file rather than editing it.

Administrative labour —

a cost objective (YBI-GA bears indirect)

2 CFR 200 Appendix IV B puts the director's office, accounting and personnel administration in the G&A pool. Treating it as an objective allocates the indirect pool to its own administration, which recovers from nobody. It is recorded on the rate either way, so the workpaper says which was chosen.

Computed rates

%

No rate yet

Seal the decision set to unlock the rate phase. A database trigger refuses any rate whose seal does not match a sealed set.

Sealed — 4dafaaa7d6eadc26...

×

Step 3 — the judgment the whole system rests on. Sealing hashes every live classification and freezes the set. Only CONTROLLER may do it and nothing automated may do it at all: a script that sealed would put the machine's name on the assertion that the rate was not fitted to a target.

Afterwards a classification can only change by unsealing with a written reason, which supersedes any rate already computed. The card now reads from the record — it said “Before sealing” over a sealed set until this walk photographed it.

COMPUTE

STEP 4 Tom · controller /rates

Computed. The basis for administrative labour is chosen on the screen rather than defaulted silently — it is worth about nine points of combined rate on the same judgments — and it is recorded on the rate. A trigger refuses any rate whose seal does not match a sealed set.

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Rates

Sealing hashes every live classification and freezes the set. Only then can a rate be computed, and the rate carries the seal — so it can be shown to be a consequence of the judgments rather than a target they were fitted to.

Sealed

Sealed by Tom Metzinger — classifications can now change only by unsealing, which supersedes the rate

Dollar coverage

100.0%

Groups left

0

The base is complete enough to seal.

☒ The books agree with themselves — all 11 cross-reference points tie.

Seal decision set

Compute the rate

Computing reads the sealed judgments and writes the rate against that seal. It is arithmetic, not a judgment — the judgment was sealing. Recomputing supersedes the rate on file rather than editing it.

Administrative labour —

in the G&A pool (it is the indirect)

2 CFR 200 Appendix IV B puts the director's office, accounting and personnel administration in the G&A pool. Treating it as an objective allocates the indirect pool to its own administration, which recovers from nobody. It is recorded on the rate either way, so the workpaper says which was chosen.

Computed rates

Rate	Pool	Base	Base amount	Rate	Status	Seal
FRINGE	401,783.6	SALARIES_WAGES	1,835,047.17	21.90%	PROPOSED	4dafaaa7d6ea...
OVERHEAD	1,497,879.12	MTDC	4,736,602.11	31.62%	PROPOSED	4dafaaa7d6ea...
G&A	585,875.91	MTDC	4,736,602.11	12.37%	PROPOSED	4dafaaa7d6ea...
INDIRECT COMBINED	2,083,755.03	MTDC	4,736,602.11	43.99%	PROPOSED	4dafaaa7d6ea...

Computed 4 rates on the POOL basis, against the seal

Step 4, and the step that could not be taken until this walk. `POST /api/rates/compute` was complete on the server, named in a comment on this very screen, and **called by nothing in the application** — so the one figure the whole engagement produces could only be made by running a script.

The basis for administrative labour is chosen here rather than defaulted silently. It is worth about nine points of combined rate on the same judgments and it is recorded on the rate, so the workpaper says which was chosen. The first version of this button sent an empty body and computed 34.82% — the default, correctly, and not the basis this engagement settled on.

Every rate carries the seal hash. A database trigger refuses one whose seal does not match a sealed set.

CHECK

STEP 5 Tom · controller /review/rate

The build-up an auditor reads. Nothing on it is computed — every figure is read from the row it was recorded in.

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Auditor's report

Indirect rate

Form 990

The three deliverables, each read from the same endpoint its workbook is built from — so a figure on the screen and the same figure in the file cannot disagree.

Fringe

Over the wage base

21.9000%

Pool	401,784
gross, as classified	401,784
less carve-outs (0)	0
Base — Salaries and wages	1,835,047

Sealed by Tom Metzinger · set "2025 build" · 4dafaaa7d6eadc26...

Overhead

Facilities and related occupancy

31.6200%

Pool	1,497,879
gross, as classified	1,497,879
less carve-outs (0)	0
Base — Modified total direct cost	4,736,602

Sealed by Tom Metzinger · set "2025 build" · 4dafaaa7d6eadc26...

General and administrative

Benefits the whole body

12.3700%

Pool	585,876
gross, as classified	585,876
less carve-outs (0)	0
Base — Modified total direct cost	4,736,602

Sealed by Tom Metzinger · set "2025 build" · 4dafaaa7d6eadc26...

Indirect, combined

Overhead and G&A, one base

43.9900%

Pool	2,083,755
gross, as classified	2,083,755
less carve-outs (0)	0
Base — Modified total direct cost	4,736,602

Sealed by Tom Metzinger · set "2025 build" · 4dafaaa7d6eadc26...

Carve-outs

What was removed from a pool before the rate was struck

Nothing has been carved out of any pool. Where a carve-out is required — the facilities share attributable to tenants, for one — it is missing rather than zero.

Take it away

The same figures, in a workbook that says on its first sheet what is unfinished

Rate build-up (.xlsx)

Step 5. The build-up an auditor reads. **Nothing on this screen is computed** — every figure is read from the row it was recorded in, because a figure derived twice is one that can disagree with itself.

Read `pool_variance` and the four anchor rows. And read what it says above the figures: the rate is a working figure while anything is unfinished, and no 200.465 facilities carve-out is in it, because no facility on the record carries measured space.

IN PARALLEL

The pre-filled sheet, offered as a convenience. It says it is optional before it says anything else, and names the three complete answers. Nothing here has been adopted for anybody.

Youngstown Business Incubator

Cost allocation · 2025

Heidi Ruby

CONTROLLER

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Timesheet

Not yet certified

RUBY · 2025 · your own record of your own time

Chargeable hours

0

Paid leave

0

recorded, not in the base

Objectives

0

This view

0

2025-03-03 to 2025-03-09

Week

Month

Mar 3 – Mar 9, 2025

What are you working from?

From my calendar

Rebuilt from diary entries — meetings, site visits, blocked time. Anything entered more than 7 days after the day worked is recorded as a reconstruction — that follows from the dates, not from what anyone says about it.

Hours

Tab across, Enter to save

Objective	Mon 3	Tue 4	Wed 5	Thu 6	Fri 7	Sat 8	Sun 9	Total
AAMEN AAMEN								
DIG-ENG Digital Engineering								
DLA DLA								
DRIVE-AM Drive AM								
HYBRID-II Hybrid II								
Day total								0

+ Add another objective

The reconstruction of your year

Not yet — and here is why

Nobody has recorded your employment terms for this period, so there are no contracted hours to divide. Until then a draft would be a year of hours against an unknown denominator. Ask the administrator to record your status, your contracted hours and the dates you worked.

Is this sheet finished?

Until you submit it, this is a work in progress and the controller's reconstruction still stands for your year. A part-filled sheet is not allowed to speak for the whole period — it would say the objectives you have reached so far were all of it.

Nobody has recorded your employment terms for 2025, so there is nothing to measure a complete period against. Ask the controller to record your status, your contracted hours and the dates you worked.

☐ This is a complete record of the time I was compensated for in 2025, including the time I was not working on any project.

Submit the sheet

What this adds up to

Leave is recorded but left out of the base — it is not a final cost objective

Nothing entered yet

Enter a week and it will appear here as a distribution you can certify.

Running in parallel, at their own pace. The controller's reconstruction of a person's year, offered to the person whose work it was.

It says **this is optional** before it says anything else, and names three complete answers: type your own days and ignore it, adopt it and correct what is wrong, or leave it. A convenience that reads as an instruction is the one way this exercise produces forty-three signatures worth nothing.

2 CFR 200.430(i) does not require a contemporaneous record — it requires one that reflects the work performed, supported and reviewed after the fact. A reconstruction the person reads, corrects and signs meets that. One nobody ever saw does not, which is where 2025 has been sitting.

Certifying is a separate act on a separate screen, and only the person whose effort it was can perform it.

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Certify your effort

Not yet signed

Period 2025 · RUBY. The signature only you can give — 2 CFR 200.430(i) asks for the person whose effort it was.

Your distribution

5 activities

Total compensation

112,467.42

Activities

5

Accounted for

100.0%

Activity	Share	Wages	Basis
YBI-GA	47.1%	52,918.11	reconstructed
HUB	28.3%	31,840.33	reconstructed
ESP	23.1%	26,024.87	reconstructed
MBAC	1.2%	1,368.34	reconstructed
AM-OTHER	0.3%	315.77	reconstructed

Certification

I certify that the distribution of effort shown above is a reasonable reflection of the total activity for which I was compensated in the period stated, across all activities, federally funded or otherwise. I understand this certification supports charges to Federal awards and that it will be relied upon by the organisation's auditors.

☐ I have read the statement above and it is true to the best of my knowledge.

Sign certification

Your name, the time, and the distribution exactly as it stands now are recorded together. If the distribution changes later, this signature is marked stale rather than quietly carried over.

Certifying is a **separate act on a separate screen**. Adopting puts hours on a sheet; signing says the sheet is true. One button doing both would take a signature from somebody who had only meant to accept a starting point.

Nobody signs for anybody else. A project manager cannot sign on their team's behalf — `v_certification_chase` is a list to go and ask, never an action.

What is outstanding, routed to the portfolio that can act on it.

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Good to see you, Tom Metzinger

Classification, the seal, and the rate that follows from it — in that order, which is the order the audit file rests on.

What is waiting on you

You hold CONTROLLER, so this is everything — each row says whose work it is

What	Items	Amount	Whose	
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✖ Square footage not on file The facilities carve-out is sized by area	1	—	FACILITIES	Open
⚠ Judgments with no document Federally chargeable, nothing cited	363	3,425,505	OFFICE	Open
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ESP ODSA / ESP	—	32	561,145	—
MBAC MBAC	—	10	278,466	—
YBI-GA YBI General Administration	—	10	264,445	—
HUB Hub	—	5	172,214	—
DRIVE-AM Drive AM	AM-DRIVE-AM	6	147,310	—
RISING-TIDES Rising Tides	—	7	106,398	—
YOUTH Youth Entrepreneurship	—	4	90,591	—
HYBRID-II Hybrid II	AM-HYBRID-P2	4	62,993	—
LTM Last Tactical Mile	AM-LTM-PROJ88	4	52,608	—
FUNDRAISING Fundraising / B&P	—	5	40,089	—
DIG-ENG Digital Engineering	AM-ICAM-DIGENG	2	30,700	—
XJET Xjet / Manufacturing Services	—	1	16,937	—
AM-OTHER America Makes — other	—	3	7,130	—
IIOT IIOT	—	1	2,777	—
VGW VGW Investment Fund	—	2	843	—
DLA DLA	—	1	401	—

What is outstanding, routed to the portfolio that can act on it. A CONTROLLER sees everything; an item whose portfolio nobody holds still reaches the controller rather than falling off the end.

Anybody holding a portfolio can recommend an item to somebody else with a reason — and that raises work, never a number.

What is deliberately missing from these pictures. No rate appears on any classification screen. No timesheet was adopted and no certification signed — those belong to the forty-three people whose effort it was, and this walk photographs the screens where they would act rather than acting for them. The sealing and the computing *were* performed, because they are controller steps being tested, and they ran against a throwaway database that was dropped afterwards.

Regenerate: `scripts/walk_runbook.py` then `scripts/runbook_guidebook.py`. The walk fails on a step that cannot be performed or a screen that comes up blank, so a picture of nothing cannot pass for a picture.